

RESOLUTION NO. _____

ENTITLED: "A RESOLUTION AUTHORIZING THE CITY OF CHEYENNE TO APPROVE AND SUBMIT THE WYOMING DIVISION OF VICTIM SERVICES FUNDING APPLICATION FOR STATE FISCAL YEAR 2025 AND 2026."

WHEREAS, pursuant to Wyoming Statute § 1-40-201 *et seq*, the Wyoming Victim and Witness Bill of Rights ensures that victims and witnesses of crime are treated with compassion, respect, and sensitivity within the criminal justice system;

WHEREAS, the primary goal of the Cheyenne Police Department Victim Assistance Program is to provide direct services to victims of crime after an incident is reported to law enforcement within city's jurisdiction;

WHEREAS, it is the Cheyenne Police Department Victim Assistance Program's mission to enhance the treatment of victims, witnesses, and survivors of criminal and non-criminal crisis situations by providing them with the assistance and services necessary to speed their physical and emotional recovery; to support and aid them through the process of the criminal justice system; and to make referrals to appropriate agencies;

WHEREAS, services provided by the Cheyenne Police Department Victim Assistance Program include the following; crisis intervention, emotional support, emergency assistance and shelter options, information and referrals to community resources, case status disposition, criminal justice advocacy and, assistance with offering and completing Crime Victim Compensation Program applications for the State of Wyoming Division of Victim Services;

WHEREAS, during the last fiscal year, of the individuals served by the Cheyenne Police Department Victim Assistance Program, nine hundred twenty-one (921) victims of violent crime were provided with one-on-one advocacy support. This support included crime scene crisis response, hospital forensic examination accompaniment, emotional support, connection to community and mental health resources, assistance with funeral preparations, liaison assistance with City and County Prosecuting Attorneys' offices, education about the criminal legal system, physical safety plan, coping skills and mental health safety planning, suicidality assessments and intervention, assistance with Crime Victim Compensation, short term financial stability assistance, intervention with landlords and employers, and referrals to specialized community support agencies;

WHEREAS, the services provided by the Cheyenne Police Department Victim Assistance Program have been crucial to the long-term stabilization and well-being of the city's community members; particularly people with lower financial stability and those with vulnerabilities, and they would not be possible without the funding and staffing necessary to provide those services and resources;

WHEREAS, the services of the Cheyenne Police Department Victim Assistance Program are funded in part by state and federal grants established by the Victims of Crime Act ("VOCA"),

the Violence Against Women Act ("VAWA"), and the Family Violence Prevention and Services Act ("FVSPA");

WHEREAS, these state and federal grants are awarded through one, or a combination of, State Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault funds, State Victim/Witness funds, State Child Advocacy funds, State Salary funds, Federal Violence Against Women Act ("VAWA") funds, Sexual Assault (SASP) funds, Federal Victim of Crime Act (VOCA) funds and Federal Family Violence Prevention Act (FVPSA) funds;

WHEREAS, pursuant to Wyoming Statute § 1-40-118, award recipients of these state and federal funds are required to submit subgrantee reports to the Wyoming Division of Victim Services ("DVS") in accordance with deadlines established through the Office on Violence Against Women and the Family Violence Prevention and Services Program;

WHEREAS, to further support its services, the City of Cheyenne Police Department Victim Assistance Program intends to apply for these funds to provide basic, direct services to victims of crime in compliance with the Wyoming Division of Victim Services Rules;

WHEREAS, the City of Cheyenne, Cheyenne Police Department Victims Assistance Program intends to apply for these funds through the WyoGrants System by Friday, March 15, 2024, for State Fiscal Years 2025 and 2026; and

WHEREAS, funding awarded through the State Division of Victim Services will be utilized by the Cheyenne Police Department Victim Assistance Program to cover approximately fifty percent (50%) of the annual employment costs for salary and benefits for one (1) full-time Victim Assistance Coordinator and two (2) full-time Victim Advocates. Funding from these state and federal grants will also be utilized to cover costs of cellular phones for staff members, office supplies, training expenses, costs associated with educational and contact brochures for the department, casework tracking software, and emergency assistance funding to assist crime victims with immediate safety, housing, and medical access concerns.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE, WYOMING, that the Governing Body approves the funding application and application process through the Wyoming Division of Victim Services State Fiscal Year 2025 and 2026 (July 1, 2025, to June 30, 2026).

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Mayor and the City Clerk are authorized to execute all documents relating to the Wyoming Division of Victim Services State Fiscal Year 2025 and 2026 (July 1, 2025, to June 30, 2026).

PRESENTED, READ AND ADOPTED this _____ day of _____,
2024.

Patrick Collins, Mayor

(SEAL)

ATTEST:

Kristina F. Jones, City Clerk